

Minutes | Board of Directors

1st Regular Meeting of the 2026-2027 Board of Directors

Weds, May 27, 2026 | 11:00am EST

Online meetings held via video conference held via **Google Meet**.

Hybrid and in-person meetings held in the **UTSU Student Commons**

Unless otherwise specified, meetings are held in open session.

Calendar Invite:  May UTSU Board Meeting

PRESENT		
Name	Title	In attendance
Executive Committee		
Marie Kinderman ▾	President	Present ▾
Tony Guo ▾	VP of Finance and Operations (VPFO)	Present ▾
Nadège Jackiw ▾	VP of Public & University Affairs (VPPUA)	Present ▾
Verona Odhiambo ▾	VP of Student Life (VPSL)	Regrets with Remorse ▾
Juan Diego Areiza ▾	VP of Equity (VPE)	Present ▾
Johnny Dong ▾	VP of Professional Faculties (VPPF)	Present ▾
Board of Directors		
Anna Oh ▾	Director-at-large	Regrets with Remorse ▾
Akash Singh Yangle ▾	Director-at-large	Regrets ▾
Areeb Naeem ▾	Director-at-large	Present (Online) ▾
Arjun Arora ▾	Director-at-large	Present ▾

Emmanuel Pasternak ▾	Director-at-large	Present ▾
Justin Pham ▾	Director-at-large	Present ▾
Safia Zaman ▾	Director-at-large	Present (Online) ▾
Wolfgang van Gulik ▾	Director-at-large	Present (Online) ▾
Yunie Kim ▾	Director-at-large	Regrets with Remorse ▾
Zac Snack ▾	Director-at-large	Present (Online) ▾
Staff, Members, Visitors and Non-voting		
Justin Pappano	Speaker	Present ▾
Jaime Nolan	Admin & Governance Coordinator	Present ▾
Ankit Sharma	General Manager	Present ▾
Media and Guests: Junia Alsinawi, Celesta Maniatogianni The Varsity Michelle He, Jasmine Chow Trin Times Sharmeen Imran The Gargoyle		

Late items submitted for inclusion on the agenda are marked in red in case the Board wishes to amend the agenda to exclude them.

1. Call to Order

This meeting is called to order at 11:01 a.m. EST

2. Agenda Approval

RESOLUTION

Moved: *Guo* (*VP FO*)

Seconded: *Kinderman* (*President*)

BE IT RESOLVED THAT the agenda be approved as presented.

BY UNANIMOUS CONSENT, RESULT: **UNANIMOUSLY CARRIED**

3. Consent Agenda Approval

RESOLUTION

Moved: *Guo* (*VP FO*)

Seconded: *Kinderman* (*President*)

☐ BOD + Committee Meeting Minutes

☐ April 12th, 2026 - Minutes | Board of Directors (for adoption)

☐ May 12th, 2026 - Agenda / Minutes | Executive Committee (for reference) &

☐ May 24th, 2026 - Agenda / Minutes | Executive Committee (for reference)

BE IT RESOLVED THAT the consent agenda be approved as presented.

BY UNANIMOUS CONSENT, RESULT: **UNANIMOUSLY CARRIED**

4. Executive Introductions

DISCUSSION

Moved: *Guo* (*VP FO*)

Seconded: *Kinderman* (*President*)

❖ **Executive Reports**

Executive officers will deliver a short introduction to the Board.

❖ **Question Period**

Executive officers receive questions from members of the Board.

- *Do the executives plan to re-use the reports template from previous years?*

Dong : Reworking the template, in our opinion of the Executive Committee, the current report structure is quite brief; we are in the process of making a report format for the next meeting.

- *Was there a duplication on Item 6 on the 2nd Executive Agenda?*

Guo : Yes. Good catch; that must be corrected.

SUMMARY: The Board heard a summary of the Executive Minutes; activities related to contacting outside organizations from the President, VPPUA, and VPE; and concerns communicated by EngSoc, which the VPPF relayed about a sudden and concerning increase of \$50 in UofT room-booking fees (that may result in undue costs in their orientation).

5. Approval for Special Rules of Order - SRO-004

RESOLUTION

Moved: **Guo** (**VP FO**)

Seconded: **Kinderman** (**President**)

WHEREAS the Executive Committee has approved and deployed the use of SRO-004, *Standards for Non-Actionable Informal Discussion*, to standardize the documentation and facilitation of informal conversation among executives;

WHEREAS the Board must approve the adoption of any applicable Standing Rules;

BE IT RESOLVED THAT, on recommendation of the Executive Committee, the Executive Committee SRO-004, as presented in Appendix A, be adopted.

RATIONALE: The Executive Committee is a subordinate body that requires the Board's approval to officially adopt a Special Rule governing the committee's conduct. Each committee would be governed by the overarching UTSU rules / parliamentary authority.

VOICE VOTING RESULT: **UNANIMOUSLY CARRIED** - NO OBJECTIONS

6. ~~Amending TORs for Committee Chairs~~

MOTION

Moved: **Guo** (**VP FO**)

BE IT RESOLVED THAT Terms of Reference, "*TOR-004, Elections & Referenda Committee*," be amended by striking "(Chair and Speaker)" after "President"

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED THAT Terms of Reference, "*TOR-005, Finance Committee*," be amended by striking "(Chair and Speaker)" after "Finance and Operations"

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED THAT Terms of Reference, "*TOR-006, Governance Committee*," be amended by striking "(Chair and Speaker)" after "Finance and Operations"

BE IT FINALLY RESOLVED THAT Terms of Reference, "*TOR-007, Member Services Committee*," be amended by striking "(Chair and Speaker)" after "President"

SUMMARY: The Chair rules that this motion is out of order because each committee has jurisdiction over maintaining its own TORs, and, customarily, they have been interpreted as guidance and references; they have never been formally adopted by the board.

7. Committee Chair Appointments

RESOLUTION

ADOPTED BY UNANIMOUS CONSENT

BE IT RESOLVED THAT *Ankit Sharma* be appointed as the chair of the Student Commons Committee, and all directors and ex officio members will sit on the committee.

BY UNANIMOUS CONSENT, RESULT: **UNANIMOUSLY CARRIED** - NO OBJECTIONS

8. Committee Chair Appointments

RESOLUTION

ADOPTED BY UNANIMOUS CONSENT

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED THAT Marie **Kinderman** be appointed to the chair of the *Governance Committee* and to the chair of the *Member Services Committee*, and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED THAT Tony **Guo** be appointed to the chair of the *Student Aid and Scholarships Committee*, and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED THAT Verona **Odhiambo** be appointed to the chair of the *Clubs and Societies Committee*, and

BE IT FINALLY RESOLVED THAT Paula Fajardo be appointed to the chair of the *People + Culture Committee*.

BY UNANIMOUS CONSENT, RESULT: **UNANIMOUSLY CARRIED** - NO OBJECTIONS

9. Committee Member Elections

RESOLUTION

ADOPTED BY UNANIMOUS CONSENT

BE IT RESOLVED THAT Emmanuel Pasternak be elected to the chair of the Elections and Referenda Committee and Directors van Gulik, Arora, Pham be elected as its members by acclamation, and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED THAT Wolfgang van Gulik be elected to the chair of the Finance Committee and Directors Arora, Naeem, Zaman be elected as its members by acclamation, and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED THAT Directors Naeem, van Gulik, Pham, and Arora be elected as the Governance Committee members by acclamation, and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED THAT Directors van Gulik, Pasternak, and Arora be elected as the Member Services Committee members by acclamation, and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED THAT Directors Pham, Pasternak, Zaman, Snack, Arora be elected as members of the Student Aid and Scholarships Committee by acclamation, and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED THAT Directors Naeem, Snack, Pham, Zaman be elected as members of the Clubs and Societies Committee by acclamation, and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED THAT Directors Zaman, Arora, Pasternak be elected as members of the People and Culture Committee by acclamation.

BY UNANIMOUS CONSENT, RESULT: UNANIMOUSLY CARRIED - NO OBJECTIONS

10. Short Presentation about the UTSU Food Bank and Regensis's Food Bank

DISCUSSION

Moved: Kinderman (President)

Seconded: Guo (VP FO)

11. Approval for an Initial Investment to Renovate the Food Bank's New Home**MOTION**Moved: *Kinderman* (*President*) Seconded: *Guo* (*VP FO*)

WHEREAS Programs and Services, and the Management Committee have expressed interest in expanding Food Bank programming and determined that the unfurnished space on the fifth floor can accommodate its proposed expansion,

WHEREAS the UofT chapter of Regenesiis has begun negotiations with the Management Committee for renting the current space where the Food Bank occupies, to run a Regenesiis-managed grocery store co-op (see Appendix B),

WHEREAS the room identified on the fifth floor is unfinished and requires funds to begin the consultation for designs, which will prioritize and begin retrofits for certain accessibility features on that floor;

BE IT RESOLVED THAT the Board, in good faith, commits to providing a reasonable monetary amount and its support in facilitating the *Programs & Services Food Bank Expansion Project*,

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED THAT the Board, in good faith, commits to providing a reasonable monetary amount and its support in facilitating the *Regenesis Grocery Co-op Project*,

BE IT FINALLY RESOLVED THAT the Board approves the transfer and use of fifty thousand (\$50k) from the Capital Fund toward the fit-out of Room 521 to initiate the UTSU Foodbank Expansion.

SUMMARY: The Board raised questions about the final clause regarding assurances that WAF funds will be used for wheelchair accessibility features. The clause was amended to draw these funds from the Capital Fund, with further consideration of WAF spending delayed until a full cost breakdown is available.

VOTING RESULT: **UNANIMOUSLY CARRIED**VOTERS SPLIT: **YEAS 7**

12. Motion to Schedule Board Meetings (BMs)

RESOLUTION

Moved: *Kinderman* (*President*)Seconded: *Guo* (*VP FO*)

BE IT RESOLVED THAT, the board dates for the 2026-2027 term during the summer term shall be as follows: **June 14, July 11 and August 8 at 1:00 PM**, meeting through hybrid means (in-person and online); &

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED THAT, the board dates for the 2026-2027 term during the academic year will be as follows: **September 10, October 7, November 11, December 2, January 13, February 10, March 11, and April 1 at 6:30 PM**, meeting through hybrid means (in-person and online).

VOTING RESULT: **UNANIMOUSLY CARRIED**

VOTER SPLIT: YEAS 6

13. Discussion about dietary preferences/meals for late-evening scheduled BMs

DISCUSSION

Moved: *Kinderman* (*President*)

SUMMARY: The Board shares dietary preferences, requests a Google Form.

14. Discussion about providing a stipend to Directors-at-large for travel to BMs

DISCUSSION

Moved: *Kinderman* (*President*)

RATIONALE: Directors-at-large are largely unpaid for their work; offering a travel subsidy to encourage directors' attendance seems equitable.

SUMMARY: Stipend of \$25 travel allowance per Board Member, per Board meeting; floated. The Executive Committee is willing to pass a motion from their budget to encourage this initiative.

15. Adjournment

RESOLUTION

WHEREAS there is no further business to discuss, the meeting is adjourned at 12:50 p.m.

APPENDICES

Consent Agenda

- Last Month's Meeting Minutes - Link: [PDF 04-13-2026 - April 2026, BOD Minutes.pdf](#)
- May 12th, 2026 - Executive Committee Reports
 - / Minutes - [PDF FINALIZED - 05-12-2026 - Executive Committee Minutes.pdf](#)
 - / Agenda - [PDF FINALIZED - 05-12-2026 - Executive Committee Agenda.pdf](#)
- May 24th, 2026 - Executive Committee Reports
 - / Minutes - [PDF FINALIZED - 05-24-2026 - Executive Committee Minutes.pdf](#)
 - / Agenda - [PDF FINALIZED - 05-24-2026 - Executive Committee Agenda.pdf](#)

Addendums

- A. Dong, Johnny, n.d., "SRO-004 | Standards for Non-Actionable Informal Discussion,"
[PDF SRO-004 Standards for Non-Actionable Informal Discussion.pdf](#)
- B. Regensis, 05-25-2026, "Proposal: Student-Run Grocery Co-op at the UTSU Student Commons," [PDF 05-25-2026 - Regensis - Proposal: Student-Run Grocery Co-op at the U...](#)